

LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT

► SHAKTIKANTA DAS

Former Governor, RBI

NBFCs

► BEST IN INNOVATION L&T Finance

► BEST IN HUMAN CAPITAL EXCELLENCE

L&T Finance

FINTECH

► BEST FINTECH IN VALUE ADDED

SERVICES: Perfios

INDIVIDUAL EXCELLENCE AWARDS

► BUSINESS TRANSFORMATION LEADER OF THE YEAR PSB: **Rajneesh Karnatak**, MD & CEO, Bank of India

► BUSINESS TRANSFORMATION LEADER OF THE YEAR Private and SFBs

Sanjay Agarwal, MD & CEO, AU Small Finance Bank

QUANTITATIVE AWARDS NON-JURY

► BEST LARGE INDIAN BANK

ICICI Bank

► BEST MID-SIZED BANK

Bank of Maharashtra

► BEST SMALL BANK

Karur Vysya Bank

► BEST FOREIGN BANK

HSBC India

► BEST SMALL FINANCE BANK

Jana Small Finance Bank

► BEST LARGE NBFC

Bajaj Finance

► BEST HOUSING FINANCE COMPANY

Bajaj Housing Finance

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ity to commit long-term capital at scale. RBI requires promoter shareholding in private banks to be diluted to 15% over time and caps the tenure of a promoter-CEO at 15 years. This makes it harder for some banks to raise growth capital. This stance is now evolving, with the RBI allowing foreign entities to acquire majority stakes in private banks, showing a shift in focus towards capital strength and global expertise.

However, this is not without trade-offs. Some experts say India cannot become a global economic power if its banking system is owned by foreign entities. "There could be a case for relaxing promoter holdings, more voting rights, allowing corporate to set up banks and permit large NBFCs in the banking space," says a

CEO of a private bank.

The entry of foreign players is just a start. Over the past year, the RBI has announced multiple reforms such as easing M&A financing, relaxing lending norms, strengthening risk management through expected credit loss (ECL) adoption from FY26, and consolidating thousands of circulars into master directions.

The message for lenders is clear: enable growth, but price risk early and manage it better. But can they?

ADVANTAGE INDIA INC

For more than two decades, Indian banks were not permitted to finance mergers and acquisitions, large-